

# Which Organizer, When?

Unit 3 · The Legislative Branch (GC.35 · GC.10–GC.15)

Match the task to the tool —  
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

**45-minute class?** Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

| WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...                       | REACH FOR                    | ≈ TIME       | BECAUSE IT WORKS                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Compare <b>two</b> things                               | ● Venn diagram · T-chart     | 10–15<br>MIN | The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>          |
| Compare <b>three or more</b> on set criteria            | ● Comparison matrix          | 15–20<br>MIN | Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.                                                 |
| Trace <b>causes &amp; effects</b>                       | ● Cause & Effect             | 15–20<br>MIN | Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>                                          |
| Put steps <b>in order</b> / show a process              | ● Timeline · Sequence        | 15–20<br>MIN | Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>                                 |
| <b>Brainstorm</b> & connect ideas                       | ● Concept web                | 10–15<br>MIN | Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.                                                |
| <b>Summarize</b> — find the main point                  | ● Main Idea & Details        | 10–15<br>MIN | Separates the big idea from the details that support it.                                                     |
| <b>Activate</b> prior knowledge & <b>track</b> learning | ● K-W-L chart                | 10–15<br>MIN | Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>                                 |
| <b>Learn a key term</b>                                 | ● Frayer model               | 10–15<br>MIN | Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.                                     |
| <b>Analyze a source</b>                                 | ● HIPPO                      | 15–20<br>MIN | Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.                                           |
| Make an <b>evidence-based claim</b>                     | ● C-E-R                      | 20–25<br>MIN | Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.                                     |
| <b>Weigh two sides</b> or options                       | ● T-chart · Problem–Solution | 15–20<br>MIN | Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.                                                    |
| Get the <b>basics of an event</b>                       | ● 5 Ws                       | 5–10<br>MIN  | Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.                                                |
| Connect the <b>nation</b> to <b>Tennessee</b>           | ★ Tennessee Connection       | 10–15<br>MIN | Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. <b>Our signature move.</b> |

# Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Unit 3 · The Legislative Branch (SSP.01) Unit 2 · Citizen Participation (SSP.01–SSP.06)

Every organizer doubles as a *skills tool*.

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 3 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

| PRACTICE | WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)                                                          | ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT               | WHERE IN UNIT 3                                                                                                                |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● SSP.01 | Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.        | 5 Ws · Main Idea & Details · K-W-L     | GC.35 citizenship (Venn); GC.14 my delegation (Concept Web / 5 Ws); K-W-L to open.                                             |
| ● SSP.02 | Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias. | HIPPO · C-E-R                          | GC.15 powers & McCulloch (source analysis / HIPPO on the opinion).                                                             |
| ● SSP.03 | Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.       | Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn | GC.10 House vs. Senate (Matrix); GC.35 natural-born vs. naturalized (Venn).                                                    |
| ● SSP.04 | Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.                      | C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution     | GC.12 House vs. Senate leadership (T-Chart); C-E-R on implied powers.                                                          |
| ● SSP.05 | Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.       | Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence   | GC.11 census → redistricting (Cause & Effect); GC.13 how a bill becomes law (Sequence).                                        |
| ● SSP.06 | Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.           | Tennessee Connection · Matrix          | Limited in Foundations; primary geographic focus lands in Unit 7 (TN State & Local). Use the ★ Tennessee Connection to bridge. |

# Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Venn · Compare Two

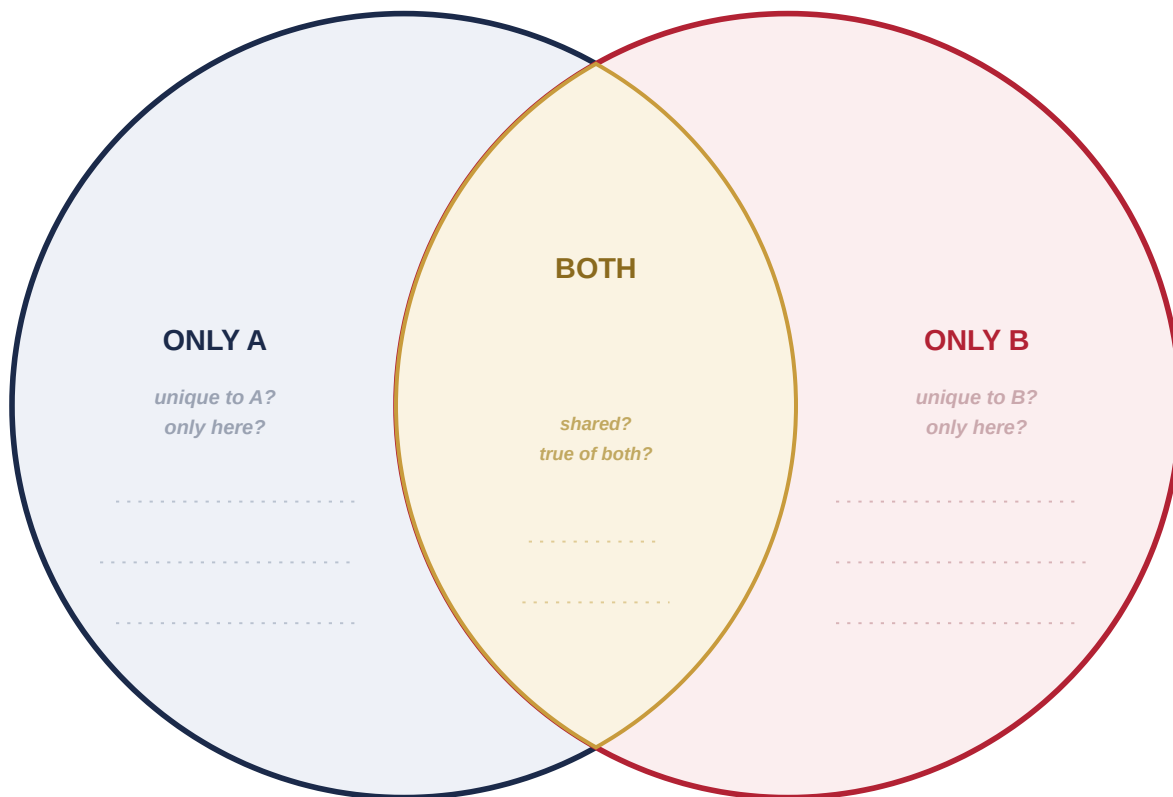
Marzano #1

**WHEN · WHY** Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

**Topic A:** \_\_\_\_\_  
write in the left circle

**Topic B:** \_\_\_\_\_  
write in the right circle



## MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

### SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

### EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

**WHEN · WHY** Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.  
*Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.*

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

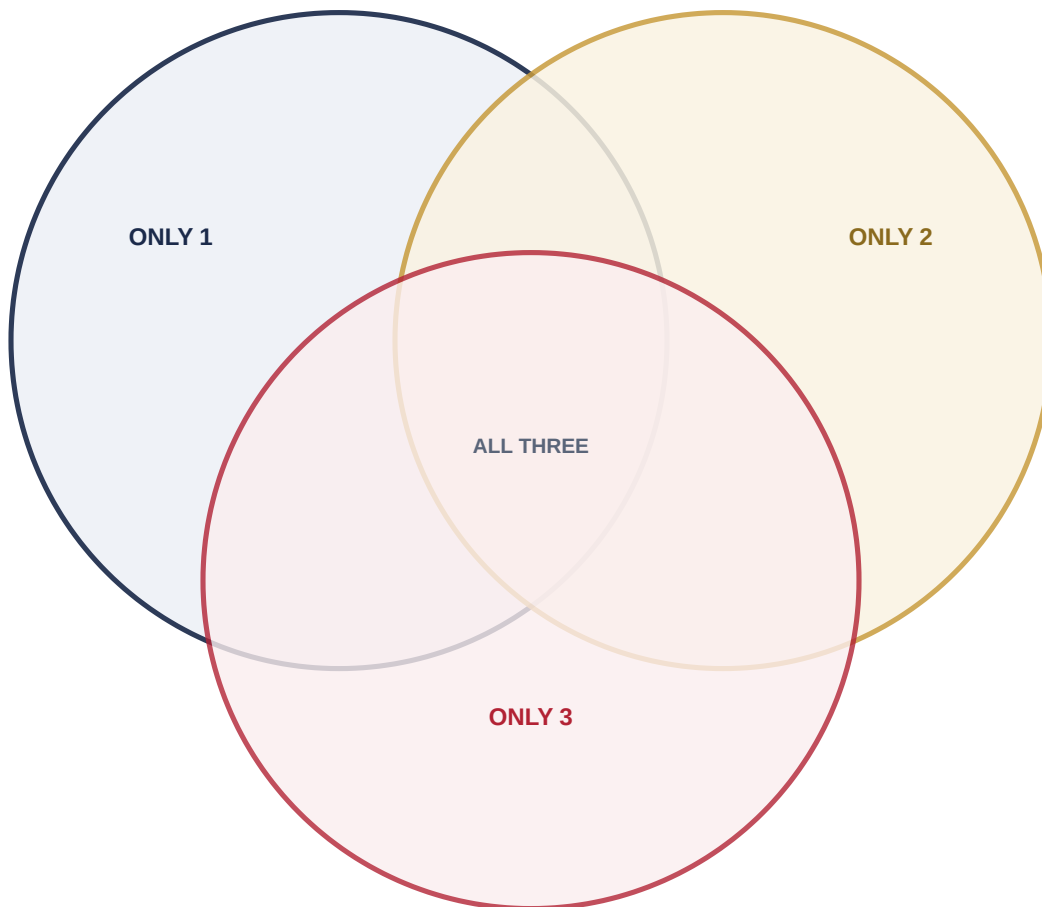
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



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**SCAFFOLD**

Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

**EXTEND**

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

## T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

**Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.**

**WHEN · WHY** When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

|             | Case 1<br>name it                                  | Case 2<br>name it | Case 3<br>name it |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Criterion A |                                                    |                   |                   |
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|             |                                                    |                   |                   |
|             |                                                    |                   |                   |
|             |                                                    |                   |                   |
| Criterion B |                                                    |                   |                   |
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| Criterion C |                                                    |                   |                   |
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|             |                                                    |                   |                   |
| PATTERN     | What pattern do you see across the cases?<br>_____ |                   |                   |

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**SCAFFOLD**  
Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

**EXTEND**  
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

**WHEN · WHY** Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

## CAUSES

## WHAT CONDITIONS MADE IT HAPPEN?

## EFFECTS

## WHAT DID IT LEAD TO?

## THE EVENT

### So what? Which single cause mattered most, and why?

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Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

**WHEN · WHY** Put events in **order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

## Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

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## Event 2 — what happened?

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## Event 3 — what happened?

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## Event 4 — why did it matter?

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#### SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

#### EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

#### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.



# Concept Web

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

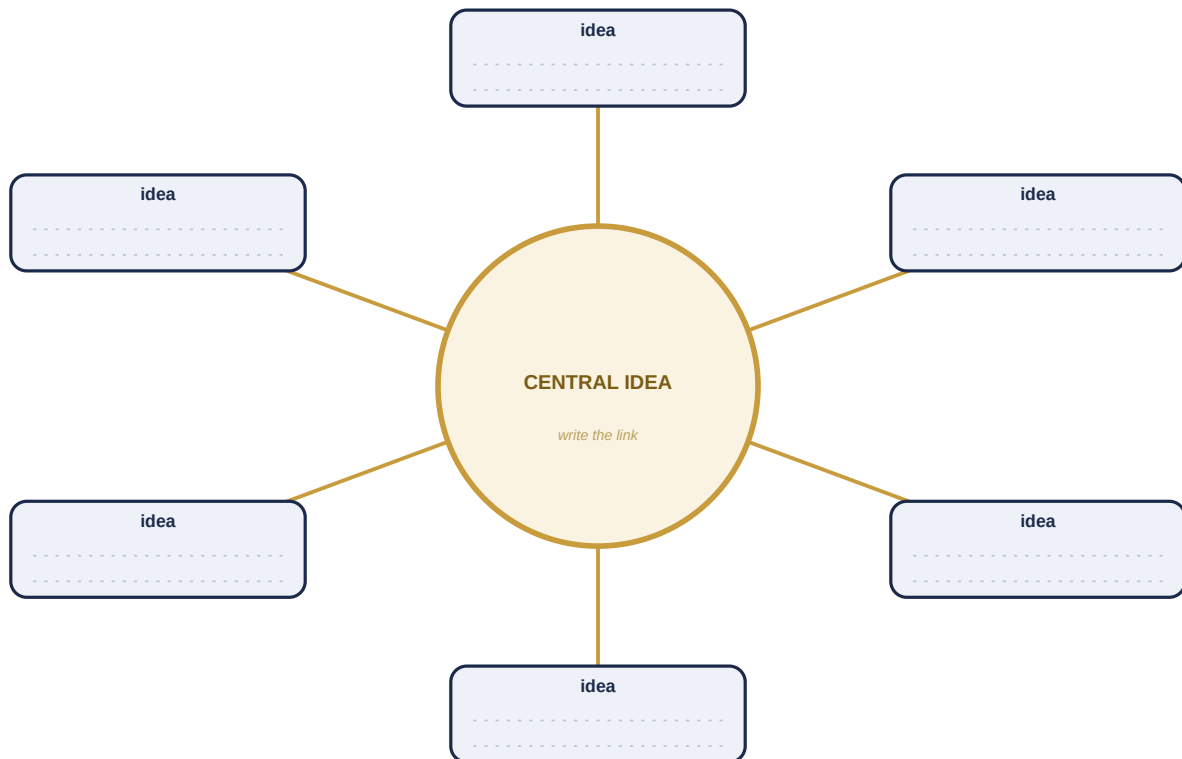
⌚ 10-15 min

Concept Web

Schema

**WHEN · WHY** **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.

**MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT** UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

**EXTEND**

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

**WHEN · WHY** Summarize by separating the big idea from the details that support it. *Distinguishing central idea from detail is core disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

In one sentence: the main idea matters because \_\_\_\_\_

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**SCAFFOLD**  
Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

**EXTEND**  
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

[illegible]

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# 5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

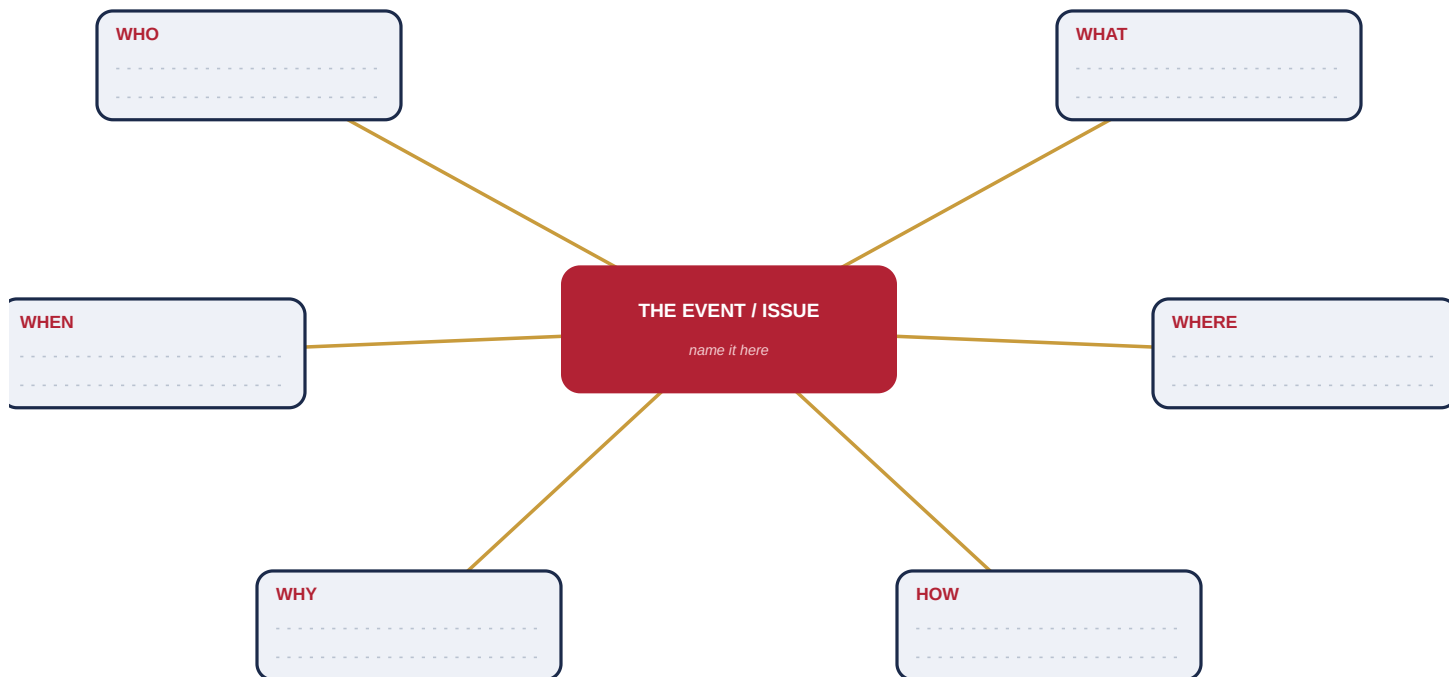
Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

5 Ws

SSP.01

**WHEN · WHY** Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.



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### SCAFFOLD

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

### EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Problem-Solution

Decision

**WHEN · WHY** Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

## THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: \_\_\_\_\_

THE IDEA

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TRADE-OFF / RESULT

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Option B: \_\_\_\_\_

THE IDEA

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TRADE-OFF / RESULT

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Best solution: \_\_\_\_\_ — because \_\_\_\_\_

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### SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

### EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Frayer Model — Key Term

⌚ 10-15 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Frayer

Vocabulary

**WHEN · WHY** Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

|                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>DEFINITION (in your words)</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> | <div>CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> |
| <div>TERM</div> <div>write the term</div>                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                           |
| <div>EXAMPLES</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div>                   | <div>EXAMPLES</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div>                           |

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**SCAFFOLD**  
Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

**EXTEND**  
Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

**WHEN · WHY** Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.  
*Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.*

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

**CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence**

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

**EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim**

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

**REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim**

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?  
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**SCAFFOLD**

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

**EXTEND**

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

HIPPO

SSP.02

**WHEN · WHY** Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: \_\_\_\_\_ title · author / creator · date · type

## H

### HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

## I

### INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

## P

### POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

## P

### PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

## O

### OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

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### SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

### EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.



★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

★ TN Connection

**Signature Move**

**Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.**

[illegible]

How are they linked? \_\_\_\_\_

**Why the local story matters:** \_\_\_\_\_

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Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.

Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to *and* different from the national one.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# Natural-Born vs. Naturalized Citizens

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

**WHEN • WHY** Both are full U.S. citizens — but they arrive by different paths, and only one may become President. A Venn makes the shared rights and the key differences visible at once. *Comparing to find shared vs. distinct traits is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

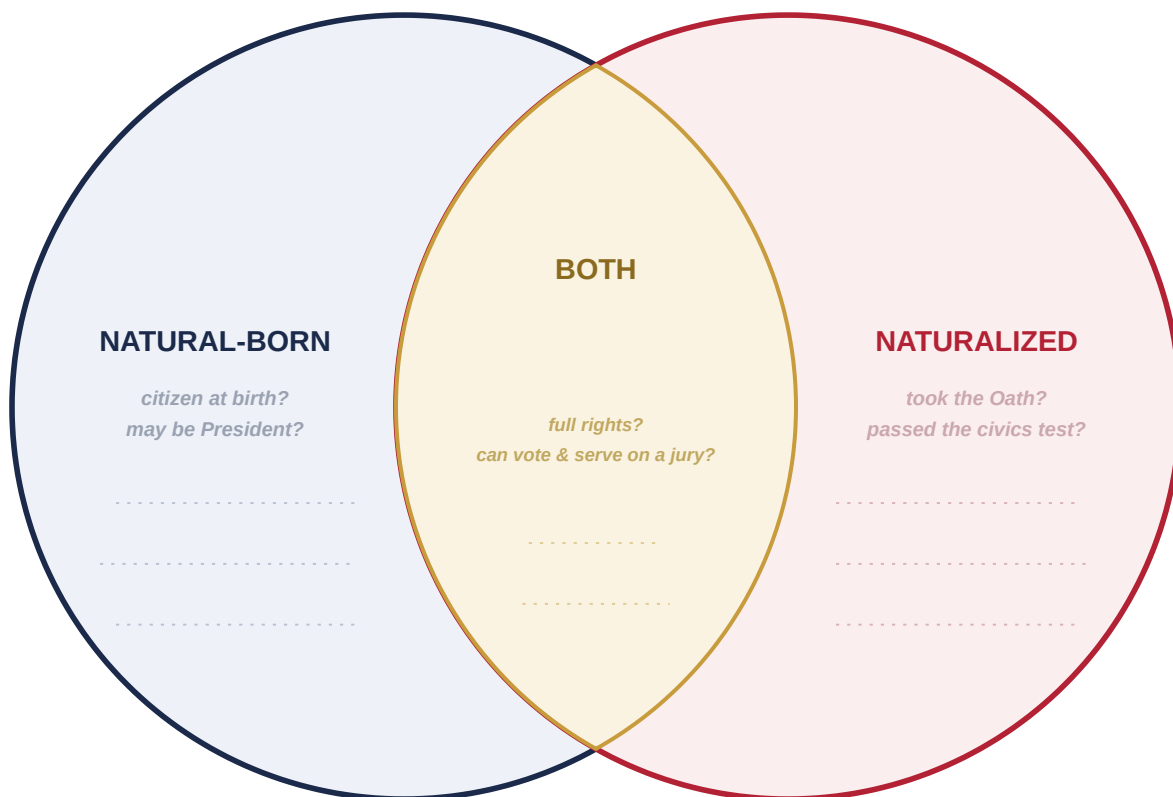
Sort each trait: only a natural-born citizen, only a naturalized citizen, or true of both.

## NATURAL-BORN

citizen at birth

## NATURALIZED

citizen by legal process



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#### SCAFFOLD

Give a card set of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

#### EXTEND

Explain why the Framers required the President to be a natural-born citizen.

#### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

House vs. Senate

⌚ 20-25 min

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Matrix · Compare Two Chambers

DOK 2 · Analyze

WHEN · WHY

Congress is bicameral by design. Holding the two chambers to the same questions makes the Framers' choices — and the 17th Amendment's change — pop. *Structured comparison against one yardstick is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Fill each cell from Article I and the 17th Amendment; then read down each column for the pattern.

|                              | HOUSE<br>chosen every 2 years | SENATE<br>6-year terms                                                                               |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Term length                  |                               |                                                                                                      |
| Minimum age                  |                               |                                                                                                      |
| Citizenship req.             |                               |                                                                                                      |
| How elected (incl. 17th Am.) |                               |                                                                                                      |
| PATTERN                      |                               | <b>Pattern:</b><br>What does the design of the two chambers tell you about the Framers' goals? _____ |

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**SCAFFOLD**  
Pre-fill the House column together; students complete the Senate column.

**EXTEND**  
Explain the significance of the 17th Amendment for how senators answer to voters.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# From Census to “One Person, One Vote”

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Cause &amp; Effect • Chain

SSP.05 • DOK 3

**WHEN • WHY** The census sets off a chain that ends in how much your vote is worth. Tracing it — through Tennessee's own Baker v. Carr — shows why redistricting is a fight worth having. *Cause-and-effect reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Work down the chain: what each step sets in motion.

**The Census (every 10 years)** — *what does the constitutional count measure?*

1

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**Apportionment** — *how are the 435 House seats split among the states?*

2

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**Redistricting** — *who redraws the lines within a state, and how can gerrymandering tilt them?*

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**Baker v. Carr (1962)** — *how did a Tennessee lawsuit lead to ‘one person, one vote’?*

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**So what?** How can drawing lines change who wins without changing a single vote?

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### SCAFFOLD

Provide the four steps on cards; students order them, then add one effect each.

### EXTEND

Explain how population shifts to cities changed Tennessee's representation before Baker v. Carr.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

## T-Chart · Two Chambers

**WHEN · WHY** Party leadership decides which bills move. Laying the House and Senate side by side shows students who holds the gavel — and who chose them. *Organizing information to reveal structure builds TN Practice SSP.01.*

## HOUSE LEADERSHIP

## SENATE LEADERSHIP

VP presides; party leaders steer

**President pro tempore** who traditionally holds this post?

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# How a Bill Becomes a Law

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Sequence · Process Flow

SSP.05 · DOK 2

**WHEN · WHY** A bill's path is a gauntlet of checks. Mapping the flow — and where the House and Senate differ — shows students why most bills never make it. *Sequencing a process builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).*

Work down the process. Note where the House and Senate rules differ.

**1** Introduction & Committee — *who introduces a bill, and why do most bills die here?*

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**2** Floor debate — *House Rules Committee limits debate; the Senate allows the filibuster (ended by cloture) — how do they differ?*

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**3** Both chambers pass identical text — *how does a conference committee reconcile differences?*

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**4** Presented to the President — *sign, or veto? How can Congress override a veto?*

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**Weigh it:** Is it too hard for a bill to become law, or is the difficulty the point?

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### SCAFFOLD

Provide the stages on cards; students order them, then mark the House/Senate difference.

### EXTEND

Explain how the filibuster and cloture change a bill's odds in the Senate.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

# My Voice in Congress

⌚ 15-20 min

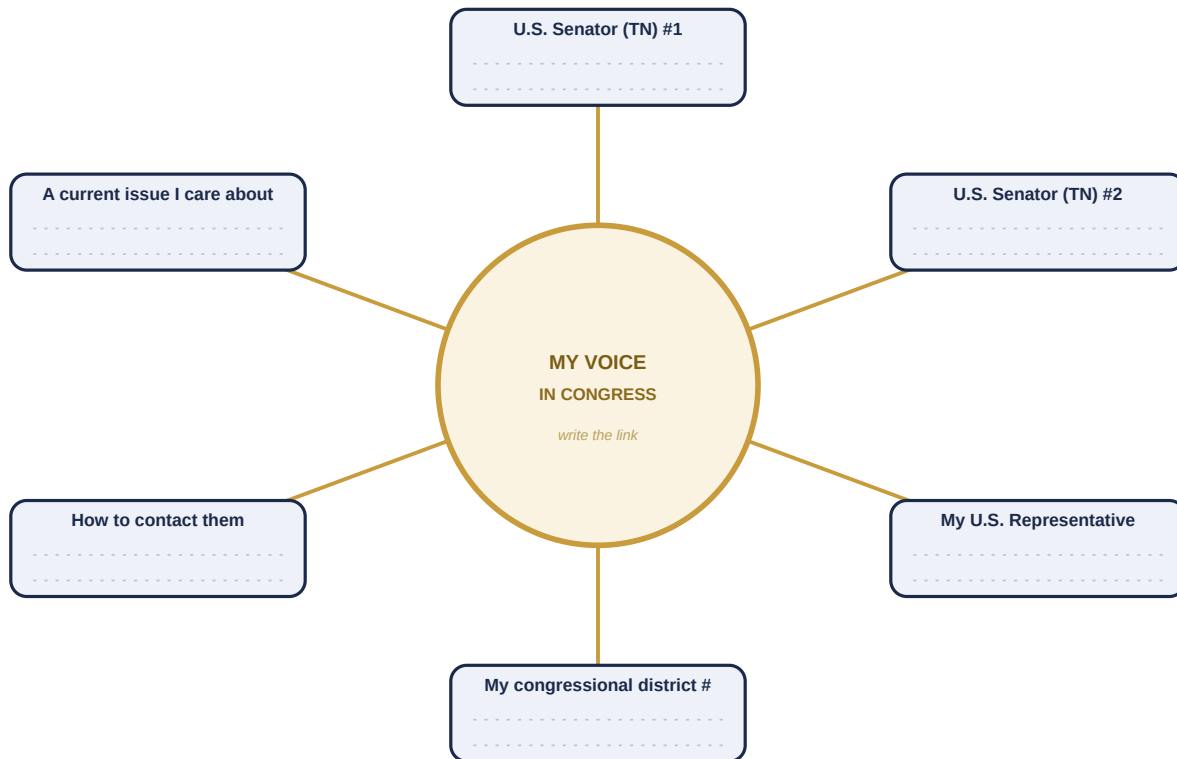
Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

Concept Web • Locate &amp; Connect

SSP.06 • DOK 2

**WHEN • WHY** Representation is only real if you can name and reach the people who hold it. This organizer turns an abstract delegation into *your* senators, *your* representative, and *your* district. *Locating oneself in place and scale builds TN geographic Practice SSP.06.*

Fill each bubble with a real name, number, or fact about who represents you.



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### SCAFFOLD

Model finding one senator together using an official directory before students research the rest.

### EXTEND

Write a one-paragraph message to a representative about the current issue you named.

### SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

**WHEN · WHY**

Congress's power comes in two kinds — the listed and the implied. Separating them, then anchoring the implied in *McCulloch v. Maryland*, shows students where federal power actually comes from. *Distinguishing central idea from supporting detail builds disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Main idea: where Congress's power comes from. Fill each column with examples.

| CONGRESS'S POWER — Article I, Section 8                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>Enumerated (listed)</div> <div>TAX? BORROW? COMMERCE? WAR?</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> | <div>Implied (Necessary &amp; Proper)</div> <div>WHAT'S THE 'ELASTIC CLAUSE' FOR?</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> | <div>McCulloch v. Maryland (1819)</div> <div>HOW DID MARSHALL EXPAND IMPLIED POWER?</div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> <div></div> |

In one sentence: Do implied powers make Congress too strong, or are they necessary to govern? \_\_\_\_\_

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

**SCAFFOLD**  
Give three enumerated powers to place first; then students add implied powers and the case.

**EXTEND**  
Explain how 'the power to tax involves the power to destroy' shaped the McCulloch ruling.

**SHOW IT YOUR WAY**  
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.